

Parkinson's Law

- Proposed by British naval historian Cyril Northcote Parkinson in 1955.
- Work expands so as to fill the time available for its completion.
- Tendency among people at work to finish their tasks only just in time for the deadline even though they are capable of completing it earlier.
- Parkinson uses the example of an elderly lady writing a postcard to her niece. Since she has nothing else to do with her time, the otherwise simple task takes up her entire day.

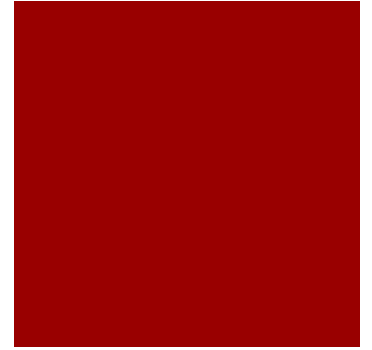
Parkinson's Law

- In his original essay, he pointed out that although navy ships decreased by two-thirds and personnel by a third, between 1914 and 1928, the number of bureaucrats still ballooned by 6% a year.
- There were fewer people and less work to manage-but management was still expanding.
- Parkinson argued that this was due to factors that were independent of naval operational need.
- 2 critical element of bureaucratization-multiplication of subordinates and bureaucrats create work for other bureaucrats.
- The tendency of managers to hire two or more subordinates to report to them so that neither is in competition with the manager themselves.

Parkinson's Law

- A pyramid starts to grow. One might add artificial layers that serve no purpose other than introducing hierarchy, that help you to promote people and please them and keep them motivated.
- When the pyramid gets very large, it eats up all the company's profit and the company will die.
- Extra time spent on a task did not lead to increased accuracy.
- When people sit down to do a task, they will put in a lot of effort initially. At some point there is going to be diminishing returns on extra effort. To optimize productivity, you need to maximize benefits and minimize costs and find that inflection point, which is where, you should start to wrap up.
- It is used as a criticism against inefficiencies of bureaucracies.

Assessment



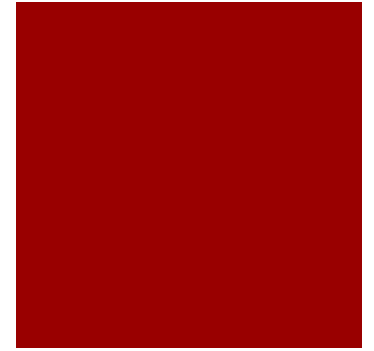
- Ideal type is a method of investigation which may or may not exist but something that is expected or is desirable.
- Informal relations within bureaucracy actually helps in the smooth functioning of the organization.

Scientific Management Approach



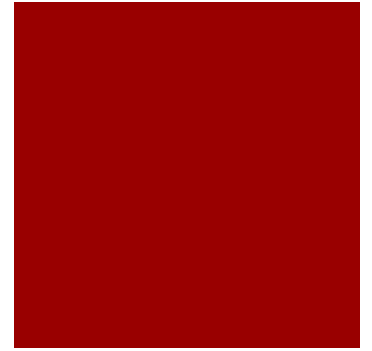
- Proposed by F.W. Taylor and advocated working in systematic manner.
- Scientific Management Involved:
 - ✓ The scientific analysis by management of all tasks which need to be done for maximum efficiency
 - ✓ Designing jobs by managers to achieve the maximum technical division of labor through advanced job fragmentation. It involves division of labor to allow for separation of tasks and functions
 - Select the best man for the job; Instruct him extensively on his work and how he should perform his work; use the carrot-and-stick approach for persuading people to try harder.

Scientific Management Approach



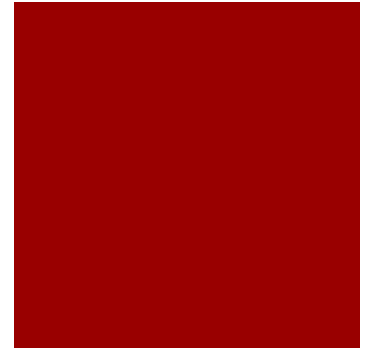
- ✓ Use of time studies to measure and describe work tasks
- ✓ Use of incentive payment systems, both to stabilize and to intensify work effort
- ✓ Manager-worker relationships at “minimum interaction model”
- The natural instinct and tendency of men to take it easy.

Assessment



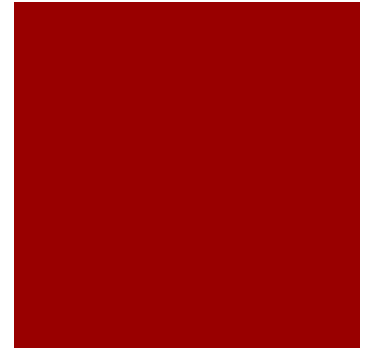
- Treats individuals as isolated units which are viewed apart from their group.
- Conception of the work is being done by the management whereas execution is done by the workers.
- Worker is deemed to be just an instrument in the production process and not a human being.

Fordism



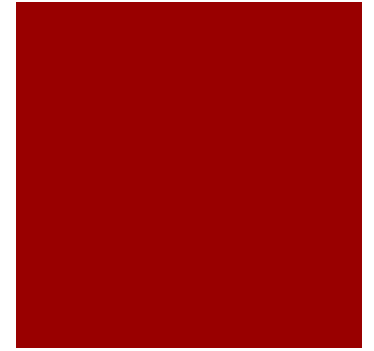
- The production process was initiated by Henry Ford, founder of Ford Motors.
- Thought of a new form of work organization that would boost the production process.
- Mass production basically split up the production process into small parts.
- The worker was reduced to a machine and he could not use his discretion while at work and he had to simply follow orders.
- Compensated workers with high wage.

Assessment



- The term 'Fordism' was coined by Antonio Gramsci in 1936.
- Was a hegemonic form of industrial organization and workers were dominated by the capitalists through control over wages and labor process.
- Alienation of Workers

Human Relations Approach



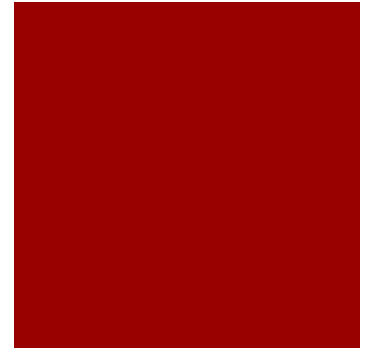
- Was proposed by Elton Mayo
- Worker's behavior can be attributed to their 'sentiments' rather than to their reason
- An emphasis on the notion of system and organic analogy.

Human Relations Approach



- The individual worker is more loyal to the informal group and is governed by the norms set by the group.
- Worker should not be looked at as some instrument in production, but as a thinking individual whose ideas are determined by the interactions they have with their co-workers.
- Consultation with workers regarding the work hours, rest, and improvement in working conditions was absolutely necessary.
- Stuart Chase in his work, “Men at Work” emphasized that factory performs two major tasks-economic and social.
- Rewards given to individual workers would have no effect unless these are ratified by the group.

Human Relations Approach



- Manager and worker have a mutual interest in promoting production.
- The leader shapes the group's behavior and helps to initiate new steps by motivating the group members.
- The goal of the industry can only be realized by the involvement of workers.
- The most important aspect of work is maintaining human dignity.

Hawthorne Effect



- Two girls were selected and asked to form their own working groups.
- Rest periods were increased and workers were given freedom to improvise their work.
- The impact of lighting on productivity levels of employees.
- The experiment was conducted with two groups of female employees.
- One group worked in a test room where level of illumination was varied experimentally.
- The second group was a control group.
- Productivity increased in both the rooms even when illumination was lowered to near darkness.
- Productivity increased because of motivational effect and friendly method of supervision.

The Bank Wiring Observation Room (BWOR)

- Second phase of the Hawthorne experiment. The bank-wiring tests began in November 1931.
- The test room housed nine wirers, three solderers, and two inspectors.
- Their job was to wire conductor banks, a repetitive and monotonous task. The work was tiring and required the workers to stand for long periods.
- Involved observation of group performing a task in a natural setting.
- An observer was placed in the room, the men began to ignore his presence and perform normally.
- The purpose of the bank-wiring tests was to observe and study social relationships and social structures within a group.
- The group had codes of conduct or norms of behavior, which were enforced by social pressures.

The Bank Wiring Observation Room (BWOR)

- The group at the front of the room considered their work more difficult than those at the back and thus felt themselves to be of higher status.
- Six thousand units were seen as a fair day's work.
- The group did not attempt to maximize output; instead they aimed for a steady flow of 6,000 units.
- Some days they would overproduce and not report the surplus until a later when they underproduced.
- This was done with the collusion of the inspectors and supervisor.

The Bank Wiring Observation Room (BWOR)

- Frictions within the bank wiring room arose because some individuals would deviate considerably from the 6000 unit norm.
- If they underperformed they were called 'chisellers' and if they overperformed they were designated as 'ratebusters'.
- They might be subjected to abuse and physical aggression.
- There were conflict between the two cliques, the low-status cliques felt insulted at being looked down on, so they underproduced in order to annoy others.
- It demonstrates that it is not sufficient to design jobs, work situations, hierarchies of authority, and payment systems.
- People will interact in much more unpredictable and complex ways than in the formal system which might be designed in line with the classical concepts.

The Bank Wiring Observation Room (BWOR)

- Research showed the most admired worker among the group was the one who demonstrated the greatest resentment of authority by slowing down production the most.
- The study findings confirmed the complexity of group relations and stressed the expectations of the group over an individual's preference.
- The researchers found that although the workers were paid according to individual productivity, productivity decreased because the men were afraid that the company would lower the base rate.